

ALMILA BASAK

CONTACT INFORMATION

Department of Political Science
Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs
Syracuse University
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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy — Political Science 2021 – 2027
Syracuse University *(Expected)*

- Fields: Comparative Politics (Major), Law and Courts (Minor)
- Dissertation: *Varieties of Right-Wing Populism Beyond Welfare Chauvinism*
- Committee: Seth K Jolly (Chair), Margarita Estevez-Abe, Jessie Trudeau

Master of Arts — Political Science 2021 – 2023
Syracuse University

Bachelor of Science - Political Science and Public Administration 2014 – 2019
Middle East Technical University, Turkey
Minor: Economics

ACADEMIC AFFILIATIONS

Graduate Research Associate 2024 – Present
Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs,
Center for European Studies, Syracuse University

Graduate Research Associate 2023 – Present
Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs,
Middle Eastern Studies Program, Syracuse University

Teaching Associate 2023 – 2026
Future Professoriate Program,
Syracuse University

Research

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Subfields: Political Parties, Comparative Political Economy, Politics of Social Policy,
Democratic Backsliding, European Politics, Turkish Politics

RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

Graduate Research Assistant, Dr. Jessie Trudeau . Spring 2026

Graduate Research Assistant, Dr. Jessie Trudeau . Spring 2025

Graduate Research Assistant, Dr. Jessie Trudeau . 2023-2024

Global Free Speech Repository Research Assistant, Dr. Thomas Keck. 2022 – 2023

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

[4] "Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers?
Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence" May 2025

- presented at the European Union Studies Association Conference with Prof Seth Jolly.
- [3] "Welfare State Policies: Window for Party Politics?," September 2024
presented at the American Political Science Association Conference.
- [2] "Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP," November 2022
presented at the Northeastern Political Science Association.
- [1] "Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP," September 2022
presented at the Political Science Research Workshop at Syracuse University.

SKILLS **Statistics Software:** R, R Studio, ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, GitHub, MAXQDA
Document Preparation Systems: L^AT_EX, R Markdown, Microsoft Office Suite

- WORKING PAPERS**
- [3] "Welfare Promises of Populist Right Parties: Whom to Attract and How to Allocate?"
- [2] "The Electoral Returns to Bending Campaign Rules: Evidence from Brazil" (with Dr. Trudeau)
- [1] "Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers? Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence" (with Dr. Jolly)

Teaching

TEACHING ASSISTANT	PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics, <i>Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe</i> Role: Section Leader	Fall 2025
	PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics, <i>Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe</i> Role: Section Leader	Fall 2024
INSTRUCTOR OF RECORD	PSC 388 Globalization and the Rise of Populism	May 2024

Grants, Awards, and Honors

GRANTS	SU Political Science Department Research Assistantship Fellowship	Spring 2026
	Roscoe Martin Fund for Graduate Research	2025
	Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs	
	Goekjian/Center for European Studies Grant	2025
	SU Political Science Department Research Assistantship Fellowship	Spring 2025
	Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant	2024
	Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant	2023

Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2022-23
Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2021-22

AWARDS	Syracuse University Political Science Department Koff Award, <i>The best graduate student paper written each year on comparative politics</i>	2025
	Syracuse University Middle East Studies Program Young Scholar Prize, for the paper” Social Policy and the Gender Gap in Party Preferences: The Case of the AKP era in Turkey”	2023
HONORS	Graduated as first-ranked student of the Middle East Technical University’s Political Science Department	June 2019
	Graduated as third-ranked student of the Middle East Technical University	June 2019

Service

TO THE INSTITUTION	Co-President , Political Science Graduate Student Association.	2023-2024
	Pre-Comprehensive Exams Student Representative , Political Science Graduate Student Association.	2022-2023
	Political Science Department Representative , Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization, Graduate Pandemic Committee member	2021-2022
TO THE DISCIPLINE	Panelist , <i>Independent Teaching as a Graduate Student</i> organized by Future Professoriate Program	October 2025
	Organizer , <i>Geocoding Workshop with Dr Trudeau</i> for Political Science Graduate Students.	October 2024
	Co-organizer , <i>Future Professoriate Program seminar: "Predocs, Postdocs, and Fellowships: What You Need to Know"</i> at Political Science Research Workshop, Syracuse University.	December 2023
PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	American Political Science Association	2024 – Present
	European Union Studies Association	2025 – Present

Updated February 2, 2026